THE HOUSE OF TATA

THE LINE OF SUCCESSION



J.R.D. TATA
Son of Jamsetji's cousin R.D. Tata and predecessor of Ratan Tata

Appointed

SIR RATAN TATA
Younger son of Tata Group founder Jamsetji Tata

NAVAJBAI SETT
Wife of Sir Ratan Tata

Adopted

SOONI TATA
Wife of Naval H. Tata

NAVAL H. TATA
Son of Hormusji Tata

SIMONE TATA
Wife of Naval H. Tata



RATAN TATA
Son of Naval H. Tata & Sooni Tata



JIMMY TATA
Son of Naval H. Tata & Sooni Tata



NOEL TATA
Son of Naval H. Tata & Simone Tata



ALOO TATA
Wife of Noel Tata and sister of Cyrus Mistry



LEAH TATA
Daughter of Noel Tata



MAYA TATA
Daughter of Noel Tata



NEVILLE TATA
Son of Noel Tata, married to Manasi Kirloskar

"Things will work much faster, the trusts will become more agile and they will be able to take quicker decisions."

Much before Ratan Tata's retirement in 2012, there was speculation that Noel would be a frontrunner to succeed him. However, the Tata Group decided to constitute a search committee to hunt for a successor. For reasons unknown, Noel's name was never put forward by the committee, which had Cyrus Mistry among others. After assessing some candidates, the committee felt that Cyrus would be the right person to lead the conglomerate. But he lost the board's trust four years into his tenure, and was removed as chairman, paving the way for Tata Group veteran N. Chandrasekaran to take over.

In 2022, Tata Sons amended its AoA to ensure that the positions of chairman of Tata Sons and Tata Trusts remain separate, so that the leadership of the two entities could pursue independent goals. Moreover, whenever a successor has to be named, a selection committee needs to be appointed. "If the question of chairmanship of Tata Sons comes up when N. Chandrasekaran retires, the same process will be followed. The candidate can be a foreigner, an Indian, or part of the Tata family. If they find Noel Tata to be good enough, they may appoint him too," says Ranina. Though for that, he'll have to give up his position at Tata Trusts.

In FY23, Tata Trusts disbursed Rs 456.4 crore for various causes, including health, nutrition, education, water and sanitation

Insiders say that Noel is very hard-working, fully devoted to his job, has an informal demeanour, and makes sure the right decisions are taken. Like Ratan Tata, he is not one to socialise, but likes to spend time on his business interests. "He is the most prominent member of the Tata family in Tata Trusts or even in the Tata Group following Ratan Tata's demise," says a Mumbai-based analyst. "He may have lost his chance 12 years ago to head the group, but right now, there is hardly anyone else who can be named as a replacement for Ratan Tata at Tata Trusts. Moreover, his several decades of experience, both in group companies and for a few years at Tata Trusts, make him an apt choice." That will be his biggest challenge too. All eyes will be on Noel as he steps into the large shoes of his illustrious predecessor. ■

Graphic by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY